

Values variables and types

Project: Python readiness portfolio

1. Prepare the purpose, prerequisites and materials

Teach the learning cycle

Primary target: Distinguish integer, floating-point, text and Boolean values

Session · Sequence and minutes · Resources

Session: Session 1 · Understand · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.

Resources: Sections 1–6; record the brief recall in the workbook.

Session: Session 2 · Practise · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–5: retrieve the procedure; 5–15: W2 completion practice; 15–23: explain and check with a partner; 23–30: each learner answers the misconception check; 30–40: targeted reteaching or a harder variation; 40–45: prepare the investigation.

Resources: Sections 7–10; use the matching workbook W2 and misconception check.

Session: Session 3 · Investigate and transfer · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–5: retrieve the decision rule; 5–20: investigate or trace; 20–30: start the independent case; 30–38: connect the project; 38–43: act on feedback; 43–45: plan the return check.

Resources: Sections 9 and 11–14. Give extra time to finish the full task set; use Section 15 when the week includes a coding lab.

This is a starting allocation of 135 minutes, not a validated duration. Preserve all named topics. Schedule extra time for connected examples, the full investigation, independent cases and project building. Repeated copies of a case share one recorded attempt; they are not new evidence.

Retrieval answer guidance

From a paper algorithm to Python

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from From a paper algorithm to Python. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Translate a short paper calculation into a Python script

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: `packs = 4; per_pack = 6; total = packs * per_pack; print(total)`, each on its own line. The first two bind quantities, the third computes 24 and the fourth displays 24. Assignment alone produces no displayed output in this script.

Focus on scalar values and rebinding; lists and mutation come later. Avoid saying every assignment makes a deep copy. For the integers used here, rebinding one name leaves the other bound to its prior value. Reference: Python tutorial introduction, <https://docs.python.org/3/tutorial/introduction.html>, and built-in types, <https://docs.python.org/3/library/stdtypes.html>.

Outcomes

Distinguish integer, floating-point, text and Boolean values

Trace reassignment without treating a name as a live formula

Choose a suitable representation for a count and an identifier

Preparation

Python 3 editor prepared in Week 1 and fresh `values.py` script

Name cards and value cards marked with `int`, `float`, `str` or `bool`

Fictional shelf labels and a blank trace table

Prerequisite answer

It displays the current value 24. Assignment and display are separate operations.

End goal for the pictorial case

Trace values variables and types and explain the changed program before running it.

This added worked case illustrates the week's main idea. Retain all original and connected topics; schedule its practice within the teaching cycle.

2. Explain and model the mechanism

A count and a shelf label can look similar while needing different operations. The integer 8 is a number; "08" is text that preserves a leading zero. You can count eight objects, but adding two shelf labels is usually meaningless. This week you will examine values, trace changes to names and explain which

representation a task needs.

Use the saved Python 3 script workflow from Week 1. Make a new file `values.py`, predict before running and keep actual output separately. Use fictional labels only. Four useful types are `int` for whole numbers, `float` for floating-point numbers, `str` for text, and `bool` for `True` or `False`. A type describes a value, not whether its meaning is sensible for the task.

`type(count)` produces the type of the value bound to `count`. These print lines display `<class 'int'>` and `<class 'str'>`. The quotes in `"08"` mark text; they are not displayed by `print(shelf)`. `True` and `False` have capital initials and no quotes. `"False"` is text, not a Boolean.

Term · Meaning

Term: Value

Meaning: A piece of data such as 8 or a text label

Term: Variable

Meaning: A name bound to a value during execution

Term: Type

Meaning: A category of value that determines available operations

Term: String

Meaning: A sequence of text characters

Term: Reassignment

Meaning: Binding an existing name to a new value

A saved value is not a live link

Instruction · count now · saved now

Instruction: `count = 8`

count now: 8

saved now: Not assigned

Instruction: saved = count

count now: 8

saved now: 8

Instruction: count = count + 2

count now: 10

saved now: 8

Evaluate the right side using the current value, then bind the left-hand name. The saved integer does not update when count is reassigned.

The new saved = count binds saved to the current 10, so print(saved) displays 10. Without that assignment it stays 8. Exit: turning "08" into 8 loses the leading zero; identifier addition has no defined meaning in the stated task. -3 is an integer but cannot be a nonnegative count.

Model the reasoning aloud

Use the complete worked example below before asking learners to complete W2. Reveal a small part, invite a prediction, then explain the deciding step. These teacher notes contain solutions; do not reveal the independent case answer during modelling.

A saved value is not a live link

Instruction · count now · saved now

Instruction: count = 8

count now: 8

saved now: Not assigned

Instruction: saved = count

count now: 8

saved now: 8

Instruction: count = count + 2

count now: 10

saved now: 8

Evaluate the right side using the current value, then bind the left-hand name. The saved integer does not update when count is reassigned.

```
count = 8
saved = count
count = count + 2
print(count)
print(saved)
```

The outputs are 10 and 8 on separate lines. `saved = count` uses the value available at that moment. It does not store a formula that keeps following count. `count = count + 2` is valid assignment: read the old 8, calculate 10, then rebind count. It is not a claim that 8 equals 10.

After count becomes 10, add `saved = count` and `print(saved)`. Predict the new output and explain why this is different from expecting saved to change automatically.

Thinking move · Teacher prompt

Thinking move: Plan

Teacher prompt: What is given? What is the question? Which procedure fits these facts?

Thinking move: Do

Teacher prompt: Point to each input and intermediate step in the worked trace. Name the rule that allows the next step.

Thinking move: Check

Teacher prompt: Does the output answer the question? Which assumption or limitation prevents a larger claim?

Use the diagram and verbal explanation together. Ask learners to match a sentence to a specific visual step; do not assign learners fixed visual or auditory learning styles.

A pictorial worked case: Values variables and types

A number and its printed-looking text. A program stores a numeric badge count and a string that looks like that count.

The facts we will use

Python 3: `count=8; tag="8"; print(count+2); print(tag+"2")`.

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Values variables and types

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. Inspect types

count is an integer; tag is a string.



2. Apply addition

Integer addition gives 10; string concatenation gives the text 82.



3. Predict a mixed operation

count+tag raises TypeError rather than silently converting tag.

CHANGE ONE THING

Change count to 10, leaving tag unchanged.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Read the picture one step at a time

Step · What happens and why

Step: 1. Inspect types

What happens and why: count is an integer; tag is a string.

Step: 2. Apply addition

What happens and why: Integer addition gives 10; string concatenation gives the text 82.

Step: 3. Predict a mixed operation

What happens and why: count+tag raises TypeError rather than silently converting tag.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

Values carry types, not merely appearances. The plus operator performs numeric addition for these integers and concatenation for these strings; the mixed operation is invalid here.

What this example does not establish

These examples use built-in integers and strings; operator behaviour depends on types and is not proof of general model reasoning.

Change one thing in the pictured case

Change: Change count to 10, leaving tag unchanged.

Prediction: The two valid outputs become 12 and 82.

Reason: Only the integer variable changes; the string still contains the character 8.

Ask while showing the picture

Cover the result. Ask learners to name the inputs and predict the next step. Uncover one step, connect the icon to the actual procedure, and explain its evidence. Then change the supplied condition and compare. The picture is a representation; it does not document execution of a real AI model.

3. Demonstrate and guide practice

Time or stage · Teacher action

Time or stage: Session 1 start to 7 minutes

Teacher action: Retrieve assignment versus print and collect the prerequisite.

Time or stage: 7 to 20 minutes

Teacher action: Compare count and shelf label; model type output and complete W1.

Time or stage: 20 to 33 minutes

Teacher action: Use the diagram and move name cards while tracing the count program.

Time or stage: 33 to 45 minutes

Teacher action: Complete W2 with predicted and actual outputs in separate columns.

Time or stage: Session 2 start to 8 minutes

Teacher action: Retrieve the two saved values and explain the extra assignment in the guided task.

Time or stage: 8 to 20 minutes

Teacher action: Run the numeric and text operations; use W3 to diagnose a `TypeError`.

Time or stage: 20 to 35 minutes

Teacher action: Collect W4 independently before support, including the seat-label choice.

Time or stage: 35 to 45 minutes

Teacher action: Complete W5 and the exit; separate type from permitted value.

Use the worked example in Sections 3 and 6. Collect a prediction before revealing its result; ask the learner to point to each intermediate fact.

Use movable name cards and immutable number cards. Keep quotations visible on text cards and show source beside output. Offer an oral trace but record assistance. Extension: explain why a type-correct number such as -3 is not acceptable as the number of seats.

Reduce help deliberately

Completion task: Trace the five-line count and saved program. Record both printed outputs, then predict the result of assigning saved = count after the change. Check with a run or label a paper trace.

Teacher check: Original outputs 10 then 8. After the new assignment, saved becomes 10. Keep actual observations separate. Reading an integer value earlier does not create a live link to another name.

Start by identifying the given inputs together. Leave the intermediate steps blank. If needed, model one step, then withdraw that help on the next step. Move to a full trace only when the partial trace is understood. For partners, alternate explainer and checker; collect a response from every learner before discussion.

Individual reasoning check

Use the worked case for Values variables and types. Proposed explanation: “Digits always mean a number”. Decide whether this explanation is supported. Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Expected correction: Quotes make a string, even when every character is a digit.

Collect explanations, not only yes/no votes. If a misunderstanding is common, re-model the relevant step for the class. If it affects a few learners, give a short targeted group explanation while others solve a more demanding variation.

Pictorial practice question

Predict both print outputs and explain why they differ. Does count+tag work, and what happens to each valid output after count becomes ten?

Reasoned teacher answer

The outputs are 10 and 82. The first adds integers; the second joins strings. count+tag raises TypeError. Changing count to 10 yields 12, while tag+"2" remains 82.

Changed-case reasoning: The two valid outputs become 12 and 82. Only the integer variable changes; the string still contains the character 8.

Collect each learner’s explanation before discussion. Use the first missing connection between input, deciding step and result to choose support. This question is worked-case practice, not fresh mastery evidence.

4. Run the investigation and diagnose misconceptions

Digits always mean a number: Quotes make a string, even when every character is a digit.

Changing one scalar name updates every earlier assignment: Trace the value bound at each assignment; no formula link is stored.

The right type guarantees valid data: A negative integer can be an invalid object count.

Lowercase false is Python’s Boolean false value: The literal is False; lowercase false is a name and is

undefined in a fresh script.

Use Section 9 for the evidence ledger. Add a boundary or missing-input case and record the expected response before checking. More successful repeats of one case do not establish wider coverage.

Match the support to the first error

What the response shows · Next teaching action

What the response shows: Missing or misread facts

Next teaching action: Read the case aloud, mark supplied versus unknown facts, and let the learner restate it.

What the response shows: Wrong procedure

Next teaching action: Return to the deciding step in the worked case. Contrast it with the proposed incorrect explanation.

What the response shows: Arithmetic or implementation error

Next teaching action: Trace intermediate values or lines; preserve the first mismatch and retry that step.

What the response shows: Correct result without a reason

Next teaching action: Ask for a trace and a changed case before marking independent understanding.

What the response shows: An unsupported wider claim

Next teaching action: Ask which supplied evidence supports the claim and which further observation would be needed.

Offer an oral explanation, drawing, enlarged visual or fewer examples when that removes a reading/writing barrier. Keep the same reasoning goal. Stretch secure learners by changing a boundary or assumption and asking them to defend the effect, not simply by assigning more of the same questions.

5. Assess and explain the answers

Guided and exit questions

The new `saved = count` binds `saved` to the current 10, so `print(saved)` displays 10. Without that assignment it stays 8. Exit: turning "08" into 8 loses the leading zero; identifier addition has no defined meaning in the

stated task. -3 is an integer but cannot be a nonnegative count.

W1 Identify the value and its type

Classify 12, 1.5, "12", False and "False". Explain why the last two are different.

12 is int; 1.5 is float; "12" is str; False is bool; "False" is str. Quotes mark text even when the characters spell a Boolean name.

W2 Trace a saved value

Trace the five-line count and saved program. Record both printed outputs, then predict the result of assigning saved = count after the change. Check with a run or label a paper trace.

Original outputs 10 then 8. After the new assignment, saved becomes 10. Keep actual observations separate. Reading an integer value earlier does not create a live link to another name.

W3 Diagnose the operation

Predict $6 + 3$, $"6" + "3"$ and $"6" * 3$. Explain what happens for $"6" + 3$. Which expression counts six groups of three?

9, text 63, text 666, and TypeError respectively. Six groups of three needs numeric multiplication $6 * 3$, giving 18; none of the listed successful expressions calculates that total.

W4 Trace a new pair of names independently

A fresh script runs `seats = 12; booked = seats; seats = seats - 5; print(seats); print(booked)`, with each statement on a separate line. Predict both outputs. Then add `booked = seats + 1` and `print(booked)`. Explain the evaluation order and choose a type for a seat label "07".

The outputs are 7 and 12, then 8 after the added assignment. The right side reads the current seats value 7 before binding booked to 8. The seat label remains str to preserve its leading zero.

W5 Separate type from validity

Give a suitable type for a counter count, a length of 2.5 metres, a shelf ID with a leading zero, and a yes-or-no availability flag. Give a count value with the right type that should still be rejected.

Use int, float, str and bool respectively. A negative integer such as -3 has type int but is invalid for a nonnegative physical count. Type checking and checking the task's permitted values are different.

Independent assessment and fresh retry

W4 needs outputs 7, 12 and 8 with a right-side-first explanation and str for "07". After support, retry with `stock = 9, spare = stock, stock = stock - 4`: printing stock and spare gives 5 and 9; `spare = stock + 2` then gives 7. Record independent reasoning before giving the retry.

Assess independent transfer

Selected case: Predict both output lines and explain why estimate stays unchanged when count is reassigned. Repeat the trace with initial count=0. Explain why note is text even though its printed characters look like a number.

```
count = 4

note = "4"

estimate = count / 2

fits = count <= 5

count = count + 3

print(count, note, estimate, fits)

print(type(count).__name__, type(note).__name__, type(estimate).__name__,
      type(fits).__name__)
```

Selected case answer

Original outputs: 7 4 2.0 True, then int str float bool. Estimate was calculated as 2.0 before reassignment; it is not a live formula. With initial count=0: 3 4 0.0 True, with the same types. Note is the quoted string "4", independent of the integer count.

Dimension · Evidence required

Dimension: Explanation

Evidence required: Names the applicable idea or procedure and ties it to the supplied facts.

Dimension: Trace and result

Evidence required: Preserves the given inputs and shows the relevant intermediate steps; distinguishes a prediction from an observed execution.

Dimension: Limits

Evidence required: States the assumptions, missing evidence or conditions under which the result would change.

Record each dimension as not yet, with support, or independent. Accept a valid alternative procedure with a defensible trace. Do not penalise an honestly recorded model failure if the learner correctly explains its evidence and limits.

Feedback that the learner uses

Name the earliest unsupported step and give one action to repair it. Have the learner make that repair now and explain why. Then assess the relevant skill on a fresh, fully specified case. Confirm it was not previously practised with feedback; solve and check the new case before assigning it. A follow-up design prompt is a starting brief, not automatically an equivalent test.

6. Connect the project, support and next lesson

Add a labelled values variables and types evidence sheet to Python readiness portfolio. Show how you can distinguish integer, floating-point, text and boolean values. Use the supplied fictional case and keep its inputs, intermediate steps, calculation or prediction, and limitation. Connect this record to last week's record; a matching answer without a trace is insufficient.

Use movable name cards and immutable number cards. Keep quotations visible on text cards and show source beside output. Offer an oral trace but record assistance. Extension: explain why a type-correct number such as -3 is not acceptable as the number of seats.

Week 3 combines numeric values in expressions and uses parentheses to make grouping explicit.

Retain the project ledger and assess a changed case after support. Check the relevant prerequisite before carrying this component forward.

Plan the delayed return

Suggested return points in this level: python-bridge/3, python-bridge/5, python-bridge/8. Use actual classroom dates, adjusting for holidays and gaps. One, three and six teaching weeks are scheduling choices, not a claimed optimal spacing.

At a delayed check, ask for the idea from memory and a changed application. Compare with the earlier independent response and record support used. For a new level, revisit the previous capstone before checking the new prerequisites.

Record · Teacher evidence

Record: Learner code and date

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Concept and case used; prior exposure

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Explanation / trace / limits

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Support and first repair

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Changed case and delayed outcome

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Next teaching action

Teacher evidence: _____

Use the evidence to choose reteaching or the next step. A completed page, confidence rating or attractive project does not by itself demonstrate understanding.

Project evidence from this case

For Python readiness before the Responsible Plant Classifier, retain a trace of the values, the predicted outputs and the changed-case explanation. Use actual Python 3 results to check the prediction after reasoning first.